

Sunshine Brioche: A Citrus-Brightened Sourdough Brioche

The Brioche Base, brightened with fresh orange juice and zest, finished with a Sunshine Glaze

DOUGH INGREDIENTS

Bread flour	500 g	100%
Fresh orange juice, cold	150 g	30%
Eggs (about 5 large), cold	250 g	50%
Stiff sourdough starter (45–50% hydration, ripe)	200 g	40%
Granulated sugar	50 g	10%
Orange zest, finely grated	10 g	2%
Fine sea salt	10 g	2%
Unsalted butter, softened	250 g	50%
Instant yeast (optional insurance)	3 g	0.6%
Total dough weight	1,420 g	

Total finished dough ~1,420 g — one generous, shareable boule or batard (divides cleanly into two smaller loaves if you'd rather). Finish cooled with the Sunshine Glaze (powdered sugar + fresh orange juice).

TIMELINE

- **Feed starter:** 8–12 hrs before mixing (stiff starter, might before), until the dome flattens and just begins to crack.
- **Zest & juice:** Zest and juice 2 medium oranges — rub 10g zest into the sugar, strain 150g juice, keep both cold.
- **Mix (DDT):** target 74–76°F (23–24°C) — cold juice & eggs help hit this. Full gluten development before butter, added in stages.
- **Bulk ferment:** Cold retard 12–16 hrs in the fridge (recommended), or room temp 4–6+ hrs @ 70–73°F. Puffy, jiggy, slow poke-test spring-back.
- **Shape:** Shape cold, straight from the fridge, into a smooth, gently taut boule. Seam-side down on a parchment-lined sheet (scored, not proofed in a banneton).
- **Proof:** Room temp 2–4 hrs @ 70–73°F, until puffy with a slow poke-test spring-back.
- **Bake:** 350°F (177°C), 35–50 min. Egg wash, score a sunburst pattern from center outward. Tent if browning too fast. Internal temp 190–195°F.
- **Cool & glaze:** 45 min–1 hr+ on a wire rack, fully cool, then drizzle with the Sunshine Glaze. Slice once set, ~15–20 min.

Recipe card — Bruce's Breads • Bruce the Bald Baker

NOTES

◆ FOLD ALONG THIS LINE, TOP PANEL BACK — STANDS LIKE A TENT ◆

NOTES